Wholesome and healthy, this chewy bread is made from oats, millet, polenta, quinoa, rice, rye, and bulgur. If you don't have one of these, replace it with one of the others.

seven-grain bread

MAKES 2 LOAVES **PREP** 20 MINS, PLUS 1½ HRS RISING **COOK** 35–40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

½ cup bulgur (cracked) wheat
⅓ cup polenta
¼ cup millet
¼ cup quinoa
1¾ cups boiling water
1¼ cups whole milk
¼ cup honey
½ cup cold water
2 tsp salt
2 tbsp vegetable oil, plus more for the bowl and for brushing
3¼ cups bread flour
⅔ cup old-fashioned (rolled) oats
⅔ cup rye, wheat, barley, or triticale flakes
two ¼oz (7g) envelopes instant yeast
1¾ cups whole wheat flour, as needed, plus more for kneading
⅓ cup cooked rice

1 Combine the first four ingredients in a bowl. Stir in the boiling water, then let stand, stirring often, for 20 minutes. Add the milk, honey, cold water, salt, and oil. Stir in the bread flour, oats, rye flakes, and yeast. Stir in enough of the whole wheat flour to make a heavy, sticky dough. Dust a work surface with flour and knead the dough for 5 minutes. Add the rice, and knead 5 minutes more or until the dough is supple. Shape the dough into a ball, and roll it around in an oiled bowl, to coat. Cover the bowl with plastic wrap, and let stand in a warm place for 1 hour, or until doubled in volume.

2 Oil two 9 x 5in (23 x 13cm) loaf pans. Knead the dough for 1 minute, cut into two pieces, and form each into a ball. Use a floured rolling pin to roll into 9 x 10in (23 x 26cm) rectangles. Starting at a short side, roll these up, and pinch the long seams to seal. Press into the pans, seam side down, to fill the pans with dough. Cover with a kitchen towel and let rise for 30 minutes.

3 Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Brush the tops of the loaves with oil and bake for 10 minutes. Reduce the heat to 375°F (190°C) and bake for 25–30 minutes or until the unmolded loaves sound hollow when tapped on the bottom. Cool briefly, then turn out onto wire racks to cool completely.